

Cary Jones

Senior Software Engineer | Python, Distributed Systems & Marketplace Platforms

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SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer with 15+ years building and operating **scalable distributed backend systems** in Python — from high-growth e-commerce platforms to enterprise-scale services processing millions of daily events. Proven ability to **own complex projects end to end**, translate ambiguous product problems into pragmatic technical solutions, and deliver reliable systems without sacrificing velocity. Collaborative technical leader experienced in code review, mentorship, and cross-functional partnership with Product, Design, and Data teams. Based in the **Los Angeles area**, aligned with Whatnot's hub-based co-location model.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Backend & Distributed Systems:** Python (FastAPI, Django, Flask, Asyncio), microservices, event-driven architecture, RESTful APIs, high-concurrency design
- **Platform Reliability:** Performance tuning, observability-minded operations, CI/CD, Docker, Kubernetes, 99.99% uptime production experience
- **Data & Infrastructure:** PostgreSQL, Redis, MongoDB, SQL optimization, AWS (ECS, Lambda, RDS, S3), GCP
- **Product Engineering:** E-commerce backends, customer-facing API design, rapid iteration, developer velocity, pragmatic trade-offs
- **Leadership:** Technical project ownership, Scrum Master, code reviews, mentoring, cross-functional delivery
- **Frontend Familiarity:** JavaScript, React.js, full-stack integration experience

KEY IMPACT

- Architected containerized Python microservices on AWS, increasing throughput by **45%** and cutting API latency below **120ms**.
- Engineered event-driven pipelines processing **2.5M+ daily transactions** with **99.95% accuracy** and built-in failure recovery.
- Automated B2B e-commerce order fulfillment at KeyIngredient, reducing manual processing by **90%** and improving seasonal campaign ROI by **15%**.
- Led engineering teams as Scrum Master, accelerating MVP timelines by **3 weeks** and raising automated test coverage from **65% to 92%**.
- Delivered enterprise backend systems at Disney with **99.99% uptime** processing **\$10M+ in daily transaction metrics**.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Principal Software Engineering Consultant / Technical Lead

Jan 2023 – Present | Los Angeles, CA / Remote

CGJSoftware, Inc.

- Own design and delivery of scalable Python backend services for e-commerce, healthcare, and data platform clients — from architecture through production operations.
 - Break down ambiguous client requirements into clear technical roadmaps; balance speed, reliability, and long-term maintainability.
 - Lead code reviews, CI/CD improvements, and mentorship while partnering with cross-functional stakeholders on high-impact outcomes.
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Senior Software Engineer

October 2021 – November 2022 | Disney Corporation, Inc. (Remote)

- Built scalable backend modules for high-volume enterprise systems, optimizing AWS infrastructure to **99.99% uptime**.
 - Co-architected automated processing systems, cutting batch runtime from **8 hours to 45 minutes** without compromising data integrity.
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Senior Software Engineer

May 2023 – July 2023 | CVS, Inc. (Remote)

- Decoupled monolithic backend into modular microservices, improving integration test speed by **50%** and enabling faster team delivery.
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Software Developer and Scrum Master

April 2014 – August 2015 | KeyIngredient — Austin, TX

- Built core **e-commerce backend REST APIs** on Google App Engine for a consumer marketplace platform.
 - Led Scrum ceremonies, peer code reviews, and backend automation — driving measurable product and operational impact.
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Python Software Developer and System Architect

July 2019 – October 2021 | CGJSoftware, Inc. (Remote)

- Designed event-driven architectures with AWS messaging, ensuring **zero data loss** during peak traffic and improving deployment frequency by **3x**.
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Field Wireman & Communications Specialist

September 1995 – September 1999 | United States Marine Corps

- Delivered under pressure with disciplined ownership, clear communication, and accountability for mission-critical outcomes.

EDUCATION

Associate of Science, Computer Electronics

2010 – 2013 | ITT Technical Institute, San Diego, CA (GPA 3.67)